

Running & Growing Your Nonprofit

Keeping a nonprofit healthy and growing takes good systems, free tools, and ongoing compliance. Below are the resources to run yours well. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Staying compliant keeps your tax-exempt status safe — the #1 way nonprofits get in trouble is missing their annual IRS filing. The free tools below save serious money as you grow.

1 Stay Compliant

Keep your tax-exempt status and good standing.

☐ File Your Annual IRS Form 990

Every nonprofit must file a 990 each year or risk losing tax-exempt status. Small nonprofits can file the simple 990-N.

→ www.irs.gov/charities-non-profits/annual-filing-and-forms

☐ Maintain State Registrations

Renew your state charitable registration and corporate filings on time.

→ www.councilofnonprofits.org/running-nonprofit/administration-and-financial-management

2 Free & Discounted Tools

Major savings that let you spend more on your mission.

☐ Google Ad Grants (\$10,000/month)

Free advertising to reach donors and the people you serve.

→ www.google.com/grants

☐ Free Google Workspace for Nonprofits

Free email, docs, and storage for your team.

→ www.google.com/nonprofits

☐ TechSoup

Discounted software, hardware, and services.

→ www.techsoup.org

3 Get Surplus Property

Nonprofits can receive free or cheap government property.

☐ Federal Surplus Property for Nonprofits

Eligible nonprofits can get surplus federal property through state agencies (SASP).

→ www.gsa.gov/buy-through-us/government-property-for-sale-or-lease/personal-property-sales/surplus-personal-property-donation-program

4 Build Skills & Capacity

Free learning and help to strengthen your organization.

☐ National Council of Nonprofits

Free guidance on management, boards, and growth.

→ www.councilofnonprofits.org

☐ SCORE & SBDC

Free mentoring also available to nonprofits.

→ www.score.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Never skip your annual 990 filing — three missed years means automatic loss of tax-exempt status. Set a recurring reminder. Watch for fake “nonprofit compliance” firms charging for free filings.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Apply for Google for Nonprofits early — the \$10,000/month in free advertising and free Workspace are among the most valuable resources available, and they cost you nothing.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national resources. For local nonprofit support, training, and surplus programs, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
